

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Operations Specialist | Blue Team, Threat Detection and Response, Network, Cloud and Endpoint Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Operations Specialist with over five years of experience in Blue Team operations, threat detection and response, and the protection of network, cloud and endpoint environments. I bring hands-on expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), vulnerability management and identity security, and I have delivered security operations across an enterprise estate of 8,000 users. I am experienced in building and refining detection logic to identify advanced threats, leading incident response activities end-to-end, and collaborating across IT and business teams to strengthen security posture. My tooling includes CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Entra ID, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Check Point Harmony firewall. I am seeking a senior cyber security operations role within a high-performing Blue Team where I can apply my detection, response and automation skills to protect critical business assets.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Blue Team and Threat Detection:** SIEM detection engineering; threat hunting; alert triage and investigation; behavioural analytics; MITRE ATT&CK mapping; detection rule development in KQL
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Tanium; endpoint forensics
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory (AD)); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Azure security
- **SIEM and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel + KQL; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; Splunk (SPL); Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks; Logic Apps
- **Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall; Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS); network segmentation; traffic analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Privileged Access:** BeyondTrust PAM; least-privilege enforcement; privileged account auditing
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle; containment and eradication; post-incident review; stakeholder reporting
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; automation playbook development
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK; NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Lead Blue Team operations across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, combining threat detection, alert triage, threat hunting and incident response to protect network, cloud and endpoint assets
- Administer and tune CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR, developing detection rules and custom Indicators of Attack (IoAs) to identify adversary behaviour mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Engineer Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and advanced KQL hunting queries to surface threats across cloud, identity and endpoint telemetry, continuously refining logic to reduce false positives
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, investigating anomalies and hypotheses derived from threat intelligence and adversary tradecraft patterns
- Lead end-to-end incident response using NIST 800-61, managing investigations from initial triage through containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review with formal reporting to senior stakeholders
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA and SSO policies alongside Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to detect identity-based attacks and enforce Zero Trust access controls

- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Discover and Insight modules to maintain asset visibility, identify shadow IT and reduce the attack surface across cloud and on-premise environments
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM to secure privileged access, enforce least-privilege and maintain comprehensive audit trails for all privileged sessions
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to orchestrate automated alert enrichment, user notification and response actions for high-volume, low-fidelity detections
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Pentra BAS and Tenable.io, translating technical findings into risk-based remediation roadmaps for IT and senior leadership

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed threat detection and alert triage across CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, investigating security events and escalating confirmed incidents to the senior team for response
- Deployed and configured Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across the 8,000-user estate, extending Blue Team visibility across endpoint and identity vectors
- Developed KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving coverage for phishing, credential theft and lateral movement attack patterns
- Maintained Microsoft Entra ID identity security controls, including Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO configurations, and supported investigations of identity-based incidents
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and risk assessment using Nessus and AppCheck, coordinating remediation plans with IT infrastructure teams
- Supported firewall policy reviews for Check Point Harmony and contributed to network segmentation improvements to reduce lateral movement risk
- Assisted with Cyber Essentials+ and CIS Controls compliance assessments, contributing technical evidence and recommendations to senior stakeholders

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Monitored and triaged security alerts from CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, responding to threats in a cloud-first SaaS and FinTech environment
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) identity controls, including MFA, SSO and Conditional Access policies, to enforce least-privilege access and protect cloud resources
- Supported vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation activities in line with NIST CSF and CIS Controls, improving the organisation's overall security posture
- Maintained Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) policies for endpoint compliance across Windows and mobile devices
- Delivered security awareness training and conducted phishing simulations, supporting a positive security culture across the workforce

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintained a comprehensive detection engineering capability at UAL using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, developing KQL detection rules across 15+ MITRE ATT&CK techniques to improve Blue Team threat coverage
- Led threat hunting operations that identified previously undetected adversary activity in the UAL environment, enabling rapid containment before escalation to a serious incident
- Designed and deployed SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to orchestrate automated response to phishing and account compromise alerts, reducing manual analyst handling time and accelerating response
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, EDR and Discover across 8,000 users, establishing real-time endpoint telemetry and enabling proactive threat hunting across the full estate
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM at UAL to establish audited privileged access controls, eliminating uncontrolled privileged account usage and supporting audit readiness

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)